

Change Management — Guided Notes ANSWER KEY

Unit 3.3.1 | CompTIA Network+ N10-009 Obj. 3.3 | N10-008 3.3

For instructor use / distribute after students complete the notes.

Question 1

Change management exists to prevent _____ changes from causing outages. Studies consistently show that a majority of network outages are caused not by hardware failure but by _____.

Answer: Unauthorized/uncontrolled; human error (misconfiguration, untested changes, changes made without a rollback plan).

Question 2

A change request must include: a description of the change, the _____ (why it's needed), the _____ window (when it will happen), and a _____ plan if the change fails or causes problems.

Answer: Business justification/reason; maintenance; rollback (backout).

Question 3

Changes are categorized by risk. A standard change is pre-approved and _____ risk (e.g., adding a VLAN to an existing port). An emergency change bypasses normal approval because of _____. What additional step is required after an emergency change is completed?

Answer: Low/routine; an active incident requiring immediate resolution. Post-implementation review and retroactive documentation/approval — the change must be recorded even though it happened outside normal process.

Question 4

Before implementing any change, the current configuration should be _____ so that the rollback plan has something to restore to. On a Cisco device, this is accomplished with the command _____.

Answer: Backed up/saved; `copy running-config startup-config` or `copy running-config tftp://` to a remote server.

Question 5

A maintenance window is a scheduled time when changes are permitted, typically during _____ usage hours. Why is it insufficient to simply schedule a maintenance window without also notifying _____?

Answer: Low (off-peak, overnight, weekend); affected users/stakeholders. Even low-traffic windows affect someone — a teacher working late, an automated backup job, a monitoring system. Notification allows users to save work and sets expectations about the planned disruption.

Question 6

A _____ review (CAB — Change Advisory Board) evaluates proposed changes before approval. In a school IT context, who would typically be stakeholders in a CAB review for a major network infrastructure change?

Answer: Change advisory; IT director, network administrator, school administrators/principals, and potentially a curriculum coordinator if instructional systems are affected.

Question 7

After a change is implemented, a _____ test verifies the change worked as intended and no unintended side effects occurred. What is the minimum documentation that should be recorded in the change ticket when the change is complete?

Answer: Post-implementation (validation/verification); actual change made, time completed, test results, any deviations from the plan, and confirmation that the rollback plan was not needed (or that it was used and what was restored).

Question 8 — Real World Application

REAL WORLD: A network admin updates a firewall rule set on a Friday afternoon without a change request, backup, or rollback plan. The change blocks access to the student grading portal. It takes until Monday morning to identify and fix the problem because the admin is unreachable over the weekend. Identify three change management failures and state what correct procedure would have prevented each.

Answer: 1. No change request — a formal request would have required impact assessment identifying grading portal traffic. 2. No backup before changes — a saved pre-change config enables immediate rollback without manual troubleshooting. 3. No maintenance window or stakeholder notification — scheduling the change for a low-impact time and notifying staff ensures someone with access and knowledge is available if something breaks.